
BRIGHTKIDCO EMAIL ECOSYSTEM
AVATAR: AUTISTIC PARENT
DOC 2 OF 6 — LEVEL 1 PROFILE
(Verbal child, low support needs, 3-5 years)
VERSION 2.0 — END-LEVEL FOR MARKETER WORKFLOW

This doc is a sub-profile within the Autistic Parent avatar.
Read DOC 1 (Master Foundation) first.

Audience share: ~35% of the Autistic Parent audience.
Selection: Pop-up option "Talks about potty but won't actually do it" → Tag: avatar_level1

TABLE OF CONTENTS

PART A: WHO IS THE LEVEL 1 MOM

1. Detailed avatar portrait
2. Demographics & context
3. The Level 1 child in detail
4. What distinguishes her from other levels

PART B: PSYCHOLOGY OF THE LEVEL 1 MOM

5. The 4 phases for Level 1
6. Symptom clusters (5 clusters)
7. Verbatim language bank (Level 1 specific)
8. Conversion trigger map

PART C: TESTIMONIAL & PROOF STRATEGY

9. Testimonial patterns for Level 1
10. Sample testimonials (long and short)
11. Which proofs have which effect

PART D: TONALITY & CALIBRATION

12. Tonality calibration per element
13. Hope vs realism balance
14. Urgency levels for Level 1

PART E: CONVERSION LEVERS

- 15. How the Big-5 levers work for Level 1
- 16. Level 1-specific additional levers
- 17. Pre-K as master driver

PART F: STRUCTURAL GUIDELINES

- 18. Forbidden phrases (Level 1 specific)
- 19. Sample openers per flow
- 20. Subject line patterns
- 21. Buyer journey mapping for Level 1

PART G: VISUAL & DESIGN CALIBRATION

- 22. Visual cues for Level 1 mails
- 23. Image direction
- 24. Tone markers in design

PART H: CHEAT SHEET & REFERENCE

- 25. Level 1 mail quick reference
- 26. Delta comparison to other levels
- 27. Cross-references

PART A: WHO IS THE LEVEL 1 MOM

1. DETAILED AVATAR PORTRAIT

THE LEVEL 1 MOM IN PORTRAIT:

Imagine Sarah. She's 33, lives in Denver, has two kids — Jake is 4, autism-diagnosed Level 1, and Emma is 18 months. Sarah works 30 hours per week as a Marketing Manager.

Jake got his diagnosis 6 months ago. He's verbal, speaks in sentences, knows letters, can count to 20. But potty training isn't working reliably. He understands intellectually what potty is. He sometimes asks about it. But following

through to action — rare, or too late.

Sarah tried Oh Crap 2 months ago. The first two days went well, but then accidents piled up. Jake cried, she cried. She stopped after 5 days. Pre-K enrollment is in 4 months. If he's not trained, he can't start.

She now googles "autism potty training Pre-K." She knows there's a reason why normal methods don't work. She's searching for autism-specific solutions.

THAT IS THE LEVEL 1 MOM.

CORE CHARACTERISTICS:

- She STILL HAS HOPE
- She is NOT cynical (yet)
- She has money to invest
- She actively searches for solutions
- She has time pressure (Pre-K)
- She is open to mechanism explanations
- She is vulnerable to hope-crash if promises break

2. DEMOGRAPHICS & CONTEXT

AGE & FAMILY:

- Mom: 28–40 years
- Often first ASD child in family
- Often: second child is neurotypical (comparison pain)
- Sometimes: is her own first child (learning everything for first time)

GEO DISTRIBUTION:

- USA: 60%
- UK: 20%
- AU/NZ: 15%
- Canada: 5%

INCOME LEVEL:

- Middle to upper-middle income dominant

- Less Medicaid usage than Level 2/3 (~10-15%)
- Disposable income available for solutions

EMPLOYMENT STATUS:

- 70% working (often part-time)
- 30% stay-at-home
- College-educated: ~70%

CHILD COMORBIDITIES (typical Level 1):

- Sensory Processing Differences: ~70% (mild)
- ADHD: ~25%
- Anxiety: ~20%
- Speech delays (mild, often already in therapy): ~30%
- GI issues: ~25% (mild)

SCHOOL/DAYCARE STATUS:

- Mainstream daycare/preschool: ~60%
- Mainstream + 1:1 or aide: ~25%
- Special preschool: ~15%

DIAGNOSIS STATUS:

- ~70% already formally diagnosed Level 1
- ~20% in evaluation
- ~10% suspected without diagnosis

3. THE LEVEL 1 CHILD IN DETAIL

AGE:

- 3-5 years dominant
- Sometimes younger 2.5, sometimes older 6

VERBAL PROFILE:

- Fully verbal
- Can form sentences
- Knows their own vocabulary (favorite topics)
- Can sometimes express needs
- But: often not at the right moment

COGNITIVE:

- Often academically advanced (letters, numbers, favorite

topics deep)

- Can follow picture books
- Understands routine concepts
- Often described as "smart but quirky"

SENSORY:

- Mild to moderate sensory differences
- Sometimes texture issues (clothing, food)
- Can often adapt to routines
- Toilet-related sensory issues: often mild

BEHAVIOR:

- Routine-oriented but more flexible than Level 2-3
- Meltdowns less frequent or shorter
- Special interests strongly expressed
- Social interest present (with hurdles)

POTTY TRAINING PROFILE — LEVEL 1 SPECIFIC:

THE TYPICAL LEVEL 1 POTTY SITUATION:

The child:

- KNOWS the concept of potty
- CAN sit on the toilet
- SHOWS interest sometimes
- HAS occasional successes (1-2× per week)
- BUT: reliably initiate — can't
- BUT: timing-accurately feel need — doesn't
- BUT: be consistent day to day — difficult

THE LEVEL 1 PARADOX:

"He gets it — but he doesn't get it."

The child understands intellectually but can't reliably act sensory-motorically. This gap between understanding and doing is the core pain of the Level 1 mom.

TYPICAL LEVEL 1 ACCIDENTS:

- Pees 5 seconds after getting up from toilet
- Says "I peed" AFTER the incident, never before
- Has a great day, then complete regression weekend
- Does it perfectly for Grandma, but not for Mom
- Sits 20 minutes on toilet, gets up, pees immediately

4. WHAT DISTINGUISHES LEVEL 1 FROM OTHER LEVELS

CORE DIFFERENCE: HOPE is intact.

VS LEVEL 2:

- Level 1 has 1-3 training attempts (Level 2: 3-5+)
- Level 1 child is verbal (Level 2: mixed)
- Level 1 mom has less BCBA experience
- Level 1 is more optimistic
- Pre-K is strong driver (with Level 2 often already addressed)

VS LEVEL 3:

- Level 1 has no "resignation" history
- Level 1 child is significantly younger
- Level 1 mom has no Medicaid pull-up routine
- Level 1 would be surprised by "non-verbal" language
- Level 1 mom doesn't think "maybe never"

IMPORTANT IMPLICATION FOR MARKETING:

Mails for Level 1 must:

- MORE hope language (but realistic)
- LESS science density
- MORE Pre-K urgency
- NO heavy resignation language
- NO Level 3 stories (misses her)

PART B: PSYCHOLOGY OF THE LEVEL 1 MOM

5. THE 4 PHASES FOR LEVEL 1

The 4 phases from DOC 1 manifest specifically for Level 1 families.

PHASE 1 FOR LEVEL 1: SLOW REALIZATION

Child 2.5–3.5 years

WHAT HAPPENS:

- First comparison pain at playground
- Other 3-year-olds are already trained
- She thinks: "boys are slower"
- Pediatrician says: "Let's check at next visit"
- First surface-level Google searches

WHAT SHE READS:

- "potty training 3 year old"
- "is my 3 year old slow"
- General parenting blogs

EMOTIONAL STATE:

- Light worry
- Optimism dominant
- Has hope for "easy fix"
- Not yet autism-oriented

DURATION OF THIS PHASE:

- 3-6 months typical
- Sometimes longer with "high-functioning" profiles

MAIL TONALITY:

- Very gentle, education-oriented
- Acknowledge "boys often take longer" (but don't reinforce)
- Introduce mechanism concept GENTLY
- Hope language OK
- No crisis language

OPENERS THAT WORK:

- "If you're starting to wonder why potty training is harder than expected..."
- "Many parents start asking around age 3..."

CONVERSION PROBABILITY IN PHASE 1: LOW (~3-5%)

PHASE 2 FOR LEVEL 1: FIRST REAL ATTEMPT

Child 3-4 years

THIS IS THE BIGGEST CONVERSION MOMENT FOR LEVEL 1.

WHAT HAPPENS:

- Buys Oh Crap book or similar
- Plans 3-day bootcamp
- Day 1: Child has 2-3 successes, she's euphoric
- Day 2: Mostly accidents, stress rises
- Day 3: Child cries, she cries, puts him back in pull-ups
- Guilt: "Maybe I gave up too fast"
- Begins autism research seriously for first time

EMOTIONAL STATE:

- First real defeat
- Self-doubt
- Compares herself to Insta success stories
- Begins autism-specific search
- Ready for different approach

WHAT SHE READS:

- "oh crap method didn't work autism"
- "potty training autism 4 year old"
- "my autistic child won't poop on toilet"
- First mention of SPD / OT
- Reddit r/autism, Facebook groups

EMOTIONAL STATE AT MAIL OPEN:

- Tired, frustrated
- But: still hopeful
- Ready for validation
- Hyper-sensitive to "this might be the answer" energy

MAIL TONALITY:

- VALIDATION-FIRST: "You did nothing wrong"
- "The method assumed something your kid couldn't do yet"
- Mechanism explanation becomes critical
- Hope language carefully — she's wounded right now
- Specific failure acknowledgment ("Day 2 was hard, right?")

OPENERS THAT WORK:

- "If you tried Oh Crap last month and it fell apart..."
- "Day 4 of bootcamp can break anyone..."
- "You didn't fail. The method assumed something he can't do yet."

CONVERSION PROBABILITY IN PHASE 2: HIGH (~15-25%)

PHASE 3 FOR LEVEL 1: METHOD CYCLING

Child 4-5 years

WHAT HAPPENS:

- Has tried 2-3 more methods (sticker chart, social story, scheduled sits)
- Some show short-term success, then regression
- Pre-K enrollment is happening — she needs trained child
- OT has mentioned "sensory issues"
- Child can now sometimes say "I need to pee", but not reliably

EMOTIONAL STATE:

- First skepticism emerges
- "I've tried everything" begins to say
- Still has hope that autism-specific solutions help
- Becomes cynical toward "general parenting advice"
- Searches for real mechanism explanations

WHAT SHE READS:

- "autism potty training 4 year old still in pull ups"
- "potty training before pre-k autism"
- "interoception autism" (first time!)
- Begins to mention Kelly Mahler in groups

MAIL TONALITY:

- Science-first (Kelly Mahler, OT quotes)
- Mechanism specificity > brand promises
- Realistic before/after stories
- 60-day guarantee as hope-risk absorber
- Pre-K timing as legitimate pressure point acknowledged
- "You're not failing — you're missing one piece"

OPENERS THAT WORK:

- "Pre-K starts in [month] and the readiness signs aren't

arriving..."

- "Sticker charts. Social stories. Scheduled sits. You've done the work. Here's what's missing..."

CONVERSION PROBABILITY IN PHASE 3: MEDIUM-HIGH (~10-18%)

PHASE 4 FOR LEVEL 1: RARE

Phase 4 is RARE for Level 1. Most Level 1 children are trained by age 6 (with or without autism-specific method).

If Phase 4 occurs for Level 1:

- Child is 6+ and still in pull-ups
- Mom has given up for "one year break"
- Plans renewed attempt before school start
- Has come to terms with "first-day-school" realism

MAIL TONALITY FOR PHASE 4 LEVEL 1:

- Very respectful
- "It's not too late" with late-trainer examples
- Longer timeline promises (8 weeks, not 3)

CONVERSION PROBABILITY IN PHASE 4: LOW (~5-8%)

PHASE SUMMARY LEVEL 1:

Phase		Share of L1 Audience	Conversion Rate
1	~15%	3-5%	
2	~50%	15-25%	
3	~30%	10-18%	
4	~5%	5-8%	

→ Phase 2 is the "fat middle" for Level 1. Email strategy should focus here.

6. SYMPTOM CLUSTERS (5 CLUSTERS)

These 5 clusters are Level 1 specific. In every mail there should be 2-3 of these clusters as recognition anchors.

SYMPTOM CLUSTER A: TIMING PROBLEMS

EXACT FORMULATIONS FROM RS:

"He says 'I need to pee' AFTER it's already happened."

"She tells me 5 seconds before, not in time."

"He'll start to pee, then run (still peeing) to the potty."

"He realizes he needs to go, but only after he's wet."

"She tells me when she's done, never when she's about to."

WHAT IT MEANS:

The signal comes — but too late or too weak. The child feels something, but the connection "signal → action" is not trained.

EMAIL IMPLICATION:

~70% of Level 1 moms recognize these symptoms. Very strong recognition hook.

SYMPTOM CLUSTER B: INCONSISTENT PERFORMANCE

EXACT FORMULATIONS FROM RS:

"Some days he's great, other days zero."

"Last week he did so well, now he won't even try."

"He went to the potty 4 times yesterday, today he's refusing."

"He goes when reminded, but never on his own."

"He had a perfect week, then a month of accidents."

WHAT IT MEANS:

The child can sometimes do it, but not reliably. Sensory regulation fluctuates — some days it works, others it doesn't.

EMAIL IMPLICATION:

"Sometimes good, sometimes not" is THE Level 1 signal.
~80% of Level 1 moms identify.

SYMPTOM CLUSTER C: VERBAL REFUSAL

EXACT FORMULATIONS FROM RS:

"He just says 'no' when I ask if he needs to pee."

"She tells me she doesn't need to go, then has an accident 10 minutes later."

"He says 'later' or 'not now'."

"She refuses to even try when she clearly needs to."

"He says he doesn't have to go, even when I can SEE he does."

WHAT IT MEANS:

The child has verbal resistance, but not sensory refusal. He doesn't FEEL that he has to go — so "I don't have to" is true from his perspective.

EMAIL IMPLICATION:

Important to reframe: this is not defiance, but missing internal signal.

SYMPTOM CLUSTER D: POTTY INTEREST WITHOUT ACTION

EXACT FORMULATIONS FROM RS:

"He LOVES potty time but won't actually go."

"She sits on it for 20 minutes, nothing happens."

"He wants to be like daddy, but can't follow through."

"She'll bring me the potty, but won't sit on it."

"He pretends to potty, mimics it perfectly, but no actual go."

WHAT IT MEANS:

Motivation and interest are there. What's missing: the internal signal that triggers action.

EMAIL IMPLICATION:

Highly specific for Level 1 — Level 2/3 often don't have this motivation.

SYMPTOM CLUSTER E: "GETS IT BUT DOESN'T GET IT"

EXACT FORMULATIONS FROM RS:

"He gets it, but he doesn't get it."

"She knows what to do, she just won't do it."

"He understands potty, talks about it, but won't follow through."

"She can explain the steps but can't execute them."

"He's so smart in everything else."

WHAT IT MEANS:

THE central Level 1 pain. Mom sees intellectual understanding, but can't explain the disconnect to action — until they understand interoception.

EMAIL IMPLICATION:

This phrase IS the Level 1 marker. When you use this language, you signal: "I see exactly your situation."

USE CASE FOR THE 5 CLUSTERS:

In EVERY Level 1 mail, 2-3 of these clusters should appear as recognition anchors. Example combinations:

Welcome E1: Cluster E + Cluster A

Welcome E2: Cluster A + Cluster B + Cluster D

Cart Aband E1: Cluster E + Cluster D

FAQ E1: Cluster B + Cluster C

7. VERBATIM LANGUAGE BANK — LEVEL 1 SPECIFIC

These quotes come directly from Level 1 family sources.

NEVER rewrite into "nicer English".

CATEGORY 1: HOW LEVEL 1 MOMS DESCRIBE THEIR CHILD

"He gets it, but he doesn't get it."

"She knows what to do, she just won't do it."

"He's 4 and still in pull-ups, but he's so smart in everything else."

"She can sing the alphabet but won't tell me she needs to pee."

"He's interested in the potty — he just won't actually use it."

"My daughter is in mainstream preschool and getting picked on because she still wears a pull-up."

"He talks about pottyng, names it, points to it on others — but won't do it himself."

"He's 'almost trained' for months now."

"She had it once, then lost it after vacation."

"He pees in the toilet at home but never at daycare."

"She tells me 'I'm a big girl' but still has accidents."

CATEGORY 2: HOW LEVEL 1 MOMS DESCRIBE FAILED METHODS

"Oh Crap stressed us both out."

"He hated the sticker chart by day 3."

"We did everything the book said and it just didn't click."

"His OT recommended timed sits — they made him hate the bathroom."

"We tried 3 different potty seats. He likes them all but won't go in any."

"We did naked weekends. He just held it for 8 hours then pooped on the rug."

CATEGORY 3: HOW LEVEL 1 MOMS DESCRIBE PROGRESS (WIN MOMENTS)

These are particularly valuable for post-purchase mails:

"He went today! Once! But he went!"

"She told me BEFORE for the first time."

"He stayed dry for 2 hours."

"She made it to the bathroom on her own."

"He said 'I peed' instead of 'I pee-peed' — that's progress."

"He held it for 90 minutes — that's a record."

"She started pulling at her pants before an accident."

CATEGORY 4: HOW LEVEL 1 MOMS EXPRESS SELF-DOUBT

"Maybe I started too late."

"I think I confused him with too many methods."

"Should I have waited longer?"

"He's not 'autistic enough' for autism methods, but normal methods don't work either."

"Am I pushing him too hard?"

"Pre-K starts in 3 months and I'm panicking."

CATEGORY 5: HOW LEVEL 1 MOMS EXPRESS PRE-K ANXIETY

"Pre-K won't take him in pull-ups."

"They said he has to be fully trained by September."

"All the other 4-year-olds are out of diapers."

"His birthday is in October — he'll be the only one in pull-ups."

"I don't know what we'll do if he can't start school."

CATEGORY 6: WHAT LEVEL 1 MOMS GOOGLE

"how to potty train autistic 4 year old"

"oh crap method autism didn't work"

"potty training before pre-k autism"

"my 4 year old keeps having accidents autism"

"autism potty training boys"

"interoception potty training autism mild"

"my autistic son understands potty but won't go"

"autism level 1 potty training methods"

8. CONVERSION TRIGGER MAP FOR LEVEL 1

When exactly does the Level 1 mom decide to buy?

PRIMARY TRIGGER #1: PRE-K DEADLINE

- Pre-K enrollment is happening
- Spring/Summer creates pressure (school starts in fall)
- "If he doesn't train, no school" fear
- Investment readiness: High
- Timeline tolerance: ~3-4 months

PRIMARY TRIGGER #2: OH-CRAP FAILURE

- Has tried standard method, failed
- Now searches for autism-specific
- "I need to try something different"
- Investment readiness: Medium-High
- Timeline tolerance: variable

PRIMARY TRIGGER #3: OT RECOMMENDATION

- OT has mentioned "sensory issues" or "interoception"
- Mom researches it now
- "If OT mentioned it, it's legit"
- Investment readiness: High (clinically validated)
- Timeline tolerance: long (trusts science)

SECONDARY TRIGGER: COMPARISON MOMENT

- Sees other kids trained at playground
- Birthday makes comparison acute
- Sibling gets older, compares
- Emotional drive to purchase

TRIGGER MOMENT TYPICAL ACTIONS:

What she does after trigger:

1. Google search (see Category 6)
2. Read Reddit / Facebook groups
3. Insta research on autism-specific products
4. Clicks Meta ad or organic post
5. Lands on BrightKidCo
6. Pop-up appears
7. If pop-up resonant: email opt-in
8. Welcome flow starts
9. 2-7 days decision period
10. Purchase or drop-off

EMAIL IMPLICATION:

- Welcome flow must be "make or break" in 7 days
- Pre-K pressure intensify when seasonal (Spring/Summer)
- OT validation prominent

- Avoid comparison sensitivity in copy

PART C: TESTIMONIAL & PROOF STRATEGY

9. TESTIMONIAL PATTERNS FOR LEVEL 1

Which testimonials work best for Level 1?

CHILD PROFILE IN TESTIMONIAL:

- Age 3-5 years (sweet spot 4)
- Verbal
- "Diagnosed Level 1" or "On the spectrum, mild support needs"
- Pre-K pressure as context (very powerful)
- Mainstream daycare/preschool
- 1-3 failed attempts mentioned

TIMELINE IN TESTIMONIAL:

- 2-6 weeks to first mini-wins
- 6-12 weeks to daytime training
- Realistic: "We're still working on poop"
- Optional: night training "comes later"

LANGUAGE PATTERNS:

- "He was so close to being trained but kept regressing"
- "Pre-K starts in September and I was terrified"
- "Within 3 weeks, he started telling me BEFORE"
- "Still working on it, but he's no longer in pull-ups"
- "We made it for pre-K with weeks to spare"

DETAILS THAT BUILD TRUST:

- Birthday mentioned (3rd, 4th, 5th)
- OT/Speech therapist mentioned
- Specific Pre-K school or daycare name
- "He's so verbal — that's not the issue"
- Authentic struggle moment

10. SAMPLE TESTIMONIALS

SHORT TESTIMONIAL (for mail inserts, ~3-5 sentences):

"My son is 4, verbal, diagnosed Level 1. We tried Oh Crap, sticker charts, even his OT had us doing scheduled sits. He'd have great days, then total regressions. Pre-K started in September.

Got the 3+3 in late July. By week 4, he was telling me 'I need pee' BEFORE not after. Pre-K accepted him in underwear with weeks to spare."

— Sarah, mom of [name], 4yo Level 1

MEDIUM TESTIMONIAL (for Welcome Education, ~8-12 sentences):

"We were in the 'almost trained' loop for months. My daughter (4, verbal, Level 1) knew everything about potty — she could explain it, narrate it, talk about it for hours. But when it came to actually going, she'd say 'not now' and pee 10 minutes later.

I tried Oh Crap. Day 4 was tears for both of us.

The 3+3 bundle came in March. Pre-K was 5 months away. The first week, more accidents than usual — but unlike pull-ups, the underwear made her PAUSE. She'd look down. By week 6, she was pulling at her pants right before an accident. That had never happened.

We're 4 months in now. She still has 1-2 accidents a day at home when she's distracted. But Pre-K accepted her in underwear. That was the goal."

— Lisa, mom of [name], 4yo Level 1 verbal

LONG TESTIMONIAL (for PDP, FAQ mails, ~15+ sentences):

"Bobby is 4.5, diagnosed Level 1 ASD with mild sensory differences. He's incredibly verbal, talks about everything. Knows all his letters, can read simple words.

But potty training was a disaster. He'd talk ABOUT going. Look forward to potty time. Sit and read books on the toilet for 20 minutes. Then get up, walk three steps, and pee his pants. He'd say 'I peed' afterward.

His OT mentioned interoception when he was 3. I researched it. Made sense intellectually but I didn't know what to DO with that information.

We tried Oh Crap when he was 3.5. Day one was great. Days 2-3 were okay. Day 4 was full meltdown. I gave up after 5 days. Felt like a failure.

His pediatrician said 'he'll get there when he's ready.'
Pre-K enrollment was looming in fall.

I got the 3+3 in March. Honestly, my expectations were low — I'd given up on 'methods.' I just wanted to try the underwear because the mechanism made sense (sustained wetness sensation, not just 'feeling wet').

Week 1: rough. He had a meltdown when he felt wet. We had a long conversation about how his body sends signals.

Week 3: he paused. He felt it. He looked at me. That had never happened.

Week 6: he started telling me 'I need pee' BEFORE the accident. Some accidents still, but a clear pattern.

Week 12: 80% daytime success. He could go to public bathrooms (sensory challenge for him before). Pre-K accepted him.

We're 5 months in now. He's not 'fully trained' — has occasional accidents during deep play. But the interoceptive feedback loop is built. That's what was missing all along."

— Sarah, mom of Bobby, 4.5yo Level 1

11. WHICH PROOFS HAVE WHICH EFFECT

PROOF RANKING FOR LEVEL 1:

#1 STRONGEST PROOF: PEER-MOM TESTIMONIAL WITH PRE-K CONTEXT

- "Pre-K accepted him with weeks to spare"
- Creates instantly relatable urgency
- Validates mechanism + timing

#2 SECOND STRONGEST: OT/THERAPIST CO-SIGN

- "His OT noticed the interoception piece"
- Clinically validated
- Reduces skepticism

#3 THIRD STRONGEST: BEFORE/AFTER WITH MICRO-WINS

- "He paused for the first time"
- "She told me BEFORE"
- Creates credible expectation

#4 FOURTH STRONGEST: NUMBER OF REVIEWS

- "16,511 reviews · 4.9 stars"
- "100,000+ parents"
- Brand-backed trust

#5 FIFTH STRONGEST: KELLY MAHLER CITATION

- Lower for Level 1 than Level 2/3
- She doesn't know Kelly Mahler often
- But: introduces her, builds authority

PROOF PLACEMENT IN MAILS:

Welcome E1: only reviews stat in footer

Welcome E2: OT citation + mechanism

Welcome E3: 1 short testimonial

Welcome E4-5: full testimonials allowed

Cart Recovery: 1 strong Pre-K testimonial

Post-Purchase: wins-pattern testimonials

PART D: TONALITY & CALIBRATION

12. TONALITY CALIBRATION PER ELEMENT

Compared to Level 2 and Level 3:

HOPE LEVEL: HIGHER than Level 2/3

- Level 1 mom may hear "this might be the thing"
- But: no "miracle" or "guaranteed"
- Language like: "Many families like yours see..."

REALISM LEVEL: MEDIUM

- Realistic timelines (6-12 weeks)
- "Some kids show signs in 2 weeks, others 8"
- Pre-K timing as realistic anchor

URGENCY LEVEL: HIGH (Pre-K driven)

- Pre-K enrollment is legitimate pressure
- "Before school starts in September" OK
- But not manipulative ("only 24 hours!")
- Soft urgency: yes. Manipulation: no.

SCIENCE DENSITY: MEDIUM-LOW

- Explain mechanism, but not too deep
- Mention Kelly Mahler, not 5-paragraph quote
- Introduce "interoception", don't assume
- BCBA language: rare (she often has no BCBA)

EMPATHY INTENSITY: MEDIUM

- She is not in deepest crisis
- Not too much "I see your pain"
- More "I see your situation"
- Acknowledge without dramatizing

TESTIMONIAL LENGTH: SHORT-MEDIUM

- Level 1 mom reads faster

- 3-8 sentences per testimonial ideal
- Multiple short > 1 long

CALL TO ACTION AGGRESSIVENESS: MEDIUM

- "See the options" is OK
 - "Let's get started" is OK
 - "Make it happen" too direct
 - Permission-not-to-buy: yes, but more subtle
-

13. HOPE VS REALISM BALANCE

THE LEVEL 1 BALANCE:

70% HOPE / 30% REALISM

Hope language:

- "This may be the thing your child needs"
- "Many families see real change"
- "Pre-K acceptance is achievable"

Realism language:

- "Some kids take 2 weeks, others 8"
- "Not every kid is the same"
- "You'll still have accidents — that's normal"
- "60 days to know if it fits your kid"

WHY 70/30?

Level 1 is vulnerable to hope crash. If a mail only sells hope and the customer fails, refund probability is high. If the mail has too much realism, she loses conversion.

Balance is: enough hope to convert, enough realism to retain.

14. URGENCY LEVELS FOR LEVEL 1

URGENCY DRIVERS FOR LEVEL 1:

#1 PRE-K DEADLINE

- Strongest driver
- Spring/Summer season
- Language: "Pre-K starts in X weeks/months"

#2 BIRTHDAY MILESTONE

- "He turns 5 in October — still in pull-ups"
- Emotional, not aggressive

#3 SIBLING PROGRESSION

- Younger sibling getting older
- Comparison stress
- Rarely directly addressable

#4 SEASONAL

- Summer as ideal training time
- "Lots of indoor time"
- "Naked weekends easier in warm weather"

HOW TO CONVEY URGENCY WITHOUT MANIPULATION:

✓ DO:

- "Pre-K starts in 4 months. That gives most kids enough runway."
- "Many parents start in summer to leverage indoor time."
- "Fall birthday — Pre-K is coming anyway."

✗ DON'T:

- "Only 24 hours left!"
- "Limited stock!"
- "Your child can't wait!"
- "Time is running out!"

PART E: CONVERSION LEVERS FOR LEVEL 1

15. HOW THE BIG-5 LEVERS WORK FOR LEVEL 1

LEVER 1 ("It's not the method"): MEDIUM-HIGH

Effect for Level 1:

- Level 1 mom has 1-3 failed attempts
- Reframe acts as validation, but not as heavy as Level 2
- "You didn't fail, the method assumed something your kid couldn't do yet" works very well

Use:

- Welcome E2, E4
- Cart Recovery E1
- FAQ E1

LEVER 2 ("Pull-ups make this worse"): MEDIUM

Effect for Level 1:

- She uses pull-ups not as long as Level 2/3
- Therefore less emotional reaction
- But: rationally compelling, intellectually engaging

Use:

- Welcome E2 (Mechanism)
- Browse Abandonment
- Cart Recovery E2

LEVER 3 ("60-Day Guarantee"): VERY HIGH

Effect for Level 1:

- Level 1 has financial flexibility
- 60 days = can try before Pre-K
- Risk removal critical after Oh Crap failure
- "Try before you commit" fits the Phase 2 mom

Use:

- Every conversion mail
- Welcome E3
- Cart Recovery final
- Checkout Abandonment

LEVER 4 ("Lena's two autistic sons"): HIGH

Effect for Level 1:

- Lena's sons are older (6 and 8) — gives hope ("they made it eventually")
- Peer-to-peer voice works very well
- Trust through experience
- Creates emotional connection

Use:

- Lena sign-off in EVERY mail
- PP-Founder Story mail
- Reply encouragement

LEVER 5 ("49% SPARK Stat"): MEDIUM

Effect for Level 1:

- Validates "this is real, not just my kid"
- But: Level 1 mom sometimes thinks "my kid is only mild"
- Stat better combined with "even mild ASD has this challenge"

Use:

- Welcome E2
- FAQ E1
- Winback

16. LEVEL 1-SPECIFIC ADDITIONAL LEVERS

ADDITIONAL LEVER L1-A: PRE-K READINESS

Language:

"Many schools require daytime training before enrollment. The 3+3 bundle gives you 60 days to see real progress — enough runway before September."

Effect:

- Very strong lever
- Intensified by season (Spring/Summer)
- Triggers active decision-making

Use:

- Spring/Summer Welcome flows
- Cart Recovery for Spring customers
- Birthday-adjacent mails

ADDITIONAL LEVER L1-B: "GETS IT BUT DOESN'T GET IT" REFRAME

Language:

"Your kid understands potty conceptually but can't execute. That's a signal-timing gap, not a comprehension gap. Here's how to bridge it."

Effect:

- Hits Level 1 mom DIRECTLY
- She knows this disconnect painfully
- Reframe opens belief shift

Use:

- Welcome E2 (Mechanism)
- FAQ E1
- Cart Recovery E2

ADDITIONAL LEVER L1-C: "VERBAL DOESN'T MEAN INDEPENDENT"

Language:

"Verbal kids on the spectrum often understand more than they can act on. That's not defiance — it's signal regulation. Even smart kids need the body-signal layer."

Effect:

- Special validation for Level 1
- Addresses "he's so smart, why can't he do this?"
- Reframe from behavior to neurology

Use:

- Welcome E1
- Cart Recovery E1
- FAQ E1

ADDITIONAL LEVER L1-D: "ALMOST TRAINED" LOOP

Language:

"'Almost trained' becomes 'still not trained' faster than you think. Each regression is sensory feedback the brain

hasn't fully wired yet."

Effect:

- Names the Level 1 reality precisely
- Creates urgency without manipulation

Use:

- Welcome E4
- Pre-K season mails
- Winback

ADDITIONAL LEVER L1-E: BEFORE PRE-K SUMMER WINDOW

Language:

"4 months of summer = ideal runway for body-signal training.
Most families see real progress by end of August."

Effect:

- Concretizes timeline
- Season-specific
- Realistic + motivating

Use:

- Spring/Summer Welcome
- Browse Abandonment (Spring/Summer)
- Pre-Birthday mails

17. PRE-K AS MASTER DRIVER

Pre-K is the most important conversion driver for Level 1.

HOW TO ADDRESS PRE-K:

DO:

- ✓ "Pre-K starts in [season]"
- ✓ "Most schools require daytime training"
- ✓ "60 days × consistency = real change before August"
- ✓ "Give your kid runway to adjust"
- ✓ "Pre-K means trained daytime, night training is later"

DON'T:

- ✗ "Your kid HAS to be trained by September!"
- ✗ "Time is running out!"
- ✗ "What will you do if he doesn't start school?"
- ✗ "Don't let your kid be the only one in diapers"
- ✗ Shaming language

PRE-K TIMING CALENDAR:

Month	Pre-K Relevance	Mail Focus
-----	-----	-----
Jan-Feb	Low	Education, low urgency
Mar	Medium (enrollment)	Mention gently
Apr	High	Pre-K enrollment peak
May	Very high	"Last chance for summer training"
Jun	Highest	"Summer training season"
Jul	Very high	"Halftime to Pre-K"
Aug	High	"Final stretch"
Sep	Medium	School start, less urgency
Oct-Dec	Low	Birthday-driven, off-season

PART F: STRUCTURAL GUIDELINES

18. FORBIDDEN PHRASES — LEVEL 1 SPECIFIC

In addition to DOC 1 Forbidden Phrases:

- ✗ "Your child is severely affected"
→ Level 1 mom thinks "no, he's mild"
- ✗ "Non-verbal kids need..."
→ Her child is verbal, she tunes out
- ✗ "Years of failed attempts"
→ She has 1-3 attempts, not 5+

- ✗ "Severe sensory issues"
→ She says "he has SOME sensory stuff, not severe"
- ✗ "Late training is normal"
→ He is 4 years old, doesn't want to be "late"
- ✗ Comparisons with Level 2/3 ("Some kids need years...")
→ Distances herself
- ✗ Heavy resignation language
→ She is not resigned
- ✗ "BCBA protocol"
→ She often has no BCBA — misses
- ✗ "Adult diapers"
→ Very off for 4-year-olds
- ✗ "Forever in pull-ups"
→ Not her reality, not her fear

19. SAMPLE OPENERS PER FLOW (LEVEL 1)

WELCOME E1 (Day 0 — Code Delivery):

Option A (Pre-K Season):

"Pre-K is closer than it sounds. Your code is below — and so is the explanation for why nothing else has worked yet."

Option B (Standard):

"Your code's below. But the more useful thing in this email might be the explanation of why your kid 'gets it but doesn't get it.'"

Option C (Phase 2 Recovery):

"If you tried Oh Crap last month and it fell apart, you're in the right place. Code's below. Real explanation follows."

WELCOME E2 (Day 1 — Mechanism):

"Your 4-year-old understands the potty. He talks about it. He sees others use it. But when it comes to actually going, something disconnects. You're not imagining it — that gap has a name."

WELCOME E3 (Day 3 — Last Day):

"Today's the last day for the code. If you're still deciding, here are three things to consider — including the question most Pre-K parents ask me."

WELCOME E4 (Day 7 — Education):

"You didn't fail at Oh Crap. The method assumed something your kid can't quite do yet — and here's exactly what."

CART ABANDONMENT E1 (Hour 1):

"You added the 3+3 bundle but didn't finish. I'm not chasing — but I want to answer the question Pre-K parents ask me most: 'Will it work in 4 months before September?'"

CART ABANDONMENT E2 (Day 1):

"Pre-K acceptance is achievable. Most Level 1 families see clear signal-recognition in 4-8 weeks. Here's what to expect in the first 30 days."

BROWSE ABANDONMENT E1 (Day 1):

"You read about the body-signal layer yesterday. The piece most parents come back to re-read is the part about why verbal kids still struggle. That's not a willpower issue."

CHECKOUT ABANDONMENT E1 (Hour 1):

"Your checkout's still open. If it's the 'will it work for us?' question — most Level 1 families see the first signs in 4-6 weeks. 60-day guarantee covers you either way."

POST-PURCHASE LEVEL-DETECTION (Day 14):

"You've had the underwear for about a week. To send the right kind of support, can I ask one quick question about

your kid?"

WINBACK PATH A:

"It's been a few months. I'm not chasing — but if your kid is still in pull-ups before Pre-K, here's something specific worth re-considering."

20. SUBJECT LINE PATTERNS FOR LEVEL 1

WELCOME FLOW SUBJECTS:

E1 Options:

- "He talks about it but won't do it"
- "Your code + the missing piece"
- "Pre-K starts in [X months]. Here's the plan."

E2 Options:

- "Your verbal kid isn't being defiant"
- "Why 'almost trained' becomes 'still not trained'"
- "The signal-timing gap, explained"

E3 Options:

- "Last day for the code"
- "Pre-K parents' biggest question"
- "Last day + 3 things to think about"

E4 Options:

- "The 4-year-old gap nobody names"
- "Why Oh Crap can fail (even when you do it right)"
- "Signal-timing > behavior-training"

E5 Options:

- "4 weeks, not 4 days"
- "What progress looks like at week 6"
- "Pre-K timeline, realistically"

E6-E8: similar patterns, shifted to "almost there" energy

CART ABANDONMENT SUBJECTS:

E1:

- "Your cart's still here"
- "Pre-K parents' #1 question"
- "Quick question before you decide"

E2:

- "60 days = before Pre-K"
- "Most Level 1 kids see signs in 4-6 weeks"
- "What happens if you wait"

E3:

- "Last reminder — your cart"
- "The bundle math + Pre-K timing"
- "60-day guarantee covers you"

BROWSE ABANDONMENT SUBJECTS:

E1:

- "You read about the body-signal layer"
- "The part most parents re-read"
- "Verbal kids + signal gap"

CHECKOUT ABANDONMENT SUBJECTS:

E1:

- "Quick question about your order"
- "Your checkout is paused"
- "The 'will it work for us?' question"

E2:

- "Last note before checkout closes"
- "Pre-K math + the 60-day guarantee"

POST-PURCHASE SUBJECTS:

Day 0 (Order Confirmation):

- "Your order is in"
- "What to expect in the next 10 days"

Day 14 (Level Detection):

- "Quick question about your kid"
- "To send the right support, can I ask..."
- "Help me help you — 30 seconds"

SUBJECT LINE NO-GOS FOR LEVEL 1:

- ✗ "Last chance" (too pressure)
 - ✗ "Miracle solution" (instant skepticism)
 - ✗ "Severe autism" (level mismatch)
 - ✗ "Years of struggles" (she hasn't struggled for years yet)
 - ✗ "Time is running out" (manipulative)
 - ✗ "Save your kid" (too dramatic)
-

21. BUYER JOURNEY MAPPING FOR LEVEL 1

WHEN SHE READS WHAT AND HOW SHE FEELS:

AWARENESS (Pre-Subscribe):

- Sees Meta ad
- Reads "for kids who 'almost' trained"
- Clicks out of curiosity
- Pop-up: "Talks about potty but won't do it" — YES, that's her kid
- Clicks email signup

WELCOME E1 (Day 0):

- Opens in car, while nursing, evening in bed
- 30 seconds attention
- Most important 2 lines: code + symptom recognition
- Click on code auto-apply: 25-30%
- Purchase in this mail: 5-10%

WELCOME E2 (Day 1):

- Opens in quieter mood (often mornings)
- 1-2 min attention
- Tipping point: "interoception" + "signal gap"
- Click on read-more: 15-20%
- Purchase after this mail: 5-8%

WELCOME E3 (Day 3 — Last Day):

- Last-chance urgency
- Decision fatigue, but permission-not-to-buy helps
- Pre-K context critical

- Purchase: 8-12%

WELCOME E4-E8 (Day 7-21):

- Decline in engagement
- Mom either bought or in "wait and see" mode
- Education mode for non-buyers
- Conversion rate drops to 2-5% per mail

CART ABANDONMENT JOURNEY:

- Added to cart, abandoned due to doubts
- E1 (1h): high open, high recovery (15-20%)
- E2 (24h): medium recovery (8-12%)
- E3 (72h): final push (5-8%)

POST-PURCHASE JOURNEY:

Day 0 (Order Confirmation):

- Excitement + slight buyer's remorse
- Reassurance critical
- Cross-sell spot open (Wash Bag etc.)

Day 7-10 (Shipping/Arrived):

- Anticipation peak
- Open rate: 60-70%
- Best upsell moment (companion products)

Day 14 (Level Detection):

- Has used product 1 week
- May have first frustrations
- Open if: realistic expectations set
- Reply rate critical for segment migration

Day 30+ (Education):

- Either pleasant surprise + reorder or refund request
- Realistic win acknowledgment helps retention

PART G: VISUAL & DESIGN CALIBRATION

22. VISUAL CUES FOR LEVEL 1 MAILS

HERO IMAGES:

✓ Verbal-kid vibes:

- Kid (3-5) interacting with mom, laughing
- Kid playing with letter toys
- Kid sitting at dinner table, eating independently
- "Smart kid" energy

✓ Pre-K context:

- Backpack, small school look
- Kid with hat/water bottle (park, outdoor)
- Backpack hanging up
- Subtle "growing up" cues

✗ Avoid:

- Heavy struggle moments
- Diaper change scenes
- Heavy sensory trigger images
- Older kids (8+) — misses Level 1

COLOR ACCENTS:

Brand-Green dominant

Cream warmth (optimism)

Soft yellows as accent (Pre-K vibe)

DESIGN PATTERNS:

- Short, scannable sections
- More whitespace (she reads faster)
- "Steps" or "Phases" visualizations
- Pre-K calendar as trust visualizer when relevant

23. IMAGE DIRECTION FOR LEVEL 1 MAILS

IMAGE DO'S:

- ✓ 3-5 year old children, often verbal-active
- ✓ Mom-kid interaction (reading, playing, talking)
- ✓ Mainstream daycare/preschool settings possible
- ✓ Backpack/outdoor/playground
- ✓ Verbal activity (singing, speaking, reading)
- ✓ Subtle smart-kid cues (letters, games)
- ✓ Bright but not over-saturated

IMAGE DON'TS:

- ✗ Non-verbal kid profile (misses)
- ✗ Older kids (6+)
- ✗ Deep sensory distress images
- ✗ Special class visuals
- ✗ Heavy struggle moments
- ✗ "Forever-in-diapers" sad-story images

PRODUCT IMAGES:

- Underwear in size for 4-year-olds
- Clear, clean, without dramatic context
- Mom-hand holding underwear is OK
- No "kid in distressing situation" context

24. TONE MARKERS IN DESIGN

DESIGN TONE FOR LEVEL 1:

OPTIMISTIC BUT GROUNDED

- Warmth through cream + soft greens
- Clear hierarchy (she scans)
- Pre-K cues subtle (backpack, calendar)

NOT:

- Overly optimistic (pastel everywhere)
- Clinically distant
- Crisis tone (too heavy)
- Marketing polish (too slick)

PART H: CHEAT SHEET & REFERENCE

25. LEVEL 1 MAIL QUICK REFERENCE

WHEN WRITING A LEVEL 1 MAIL, CHECK:

BEFORE WRITING:

- ☐ Which phase is the mom? (Phase 2 is most common)
- ☐ Which of the 5 symptom clusters fits?
- ☐ Is Pre-K season relevant?
- ☐ Which flow + which mail position?

WHILE WRITING:

- ☐ Did I mention 2-3 symptom anchors?
- ☐ Did I balance hope-realism 70/30?
- ☐ Did I use "verbal" / "almost trained" / "gets it but" language?
- ☐ Pre-K mentioned when relevant (season)?
- ☐ Lena sign-off per Section 20?
- ☐ Realistic timeline (weeks, not days)?

AFTER WRITING:

- ☐ Forbidden phrases checked (Section 18)?
- ☐ Tonality calibration fits (Section 12)?
- ☐ Mobile-first layout (short sections)?
- ☐ Subject lines 3 options created?
- ☐ Preheaders 3 options created?

ONE-LINE SUMMARY OF LEVEL 1:

"The child understands it, can sometimes do it, but can't do it consistently — and Pre-K is coming."

26. DELTA COMPARISON TO OTHER LEVELS

Dimension	Level 1	Level 2	Level 3
Child Age	3-5	5-7	6-10+
Verbal Status	Verbal	Mixed	Non/minimal
Tried Methods	1-3	3-5+	5+ (years)
Pull-up Size	4-5	5-7	7-8+, adult
Hope Level	Intact	Cracks	Accepted
Skepticism	Low	Very high	Deep, calm
Pre-K Pressure	Very strong	Weak	Not relevant
BCBA Context	Rare	Almost always	Long-term
Empathy Need	Medium	High	Very high
Science	Low-Medium	High	Medium-high
Testimonial Length	Short-Medium	Long	Long+messy
CTA Aggressiveness	Medium	Low	Very low
Urgency Allowed	High (Pre-K)	Little	Never

27. CROSS-REFERENCES

For cross-level mails:

→ DOC 5 (General Fallback) for cross-level language

For Cart/Checkout/Browse Abandonment:

→ DOC 5 dominant (cross-level)

→ If level tag known: DOC 2-4 for calibration

For Welcome Flow Level 1 variant:

→ DOC 2 (this doc) primary

→ DOC 1 for brand voice and master foundation

For FAQ/Objection (Phase 3):

→ DOC 2 for Level 1 variant

→ DOC 1 objection map section

For RS-PDF consultation:

→ Autistic_Parent.pdf

→ Autistic_language_Bank.pdf

→ Autistic_MIRO_m.pdf

END OF DOC 2 EN — LEVEL 1 PROFILE

NEXT RESPONSE: DOC 3 EN — LEVEL 2 PROFILE
